

0.0.1 Sela

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One while wandering on tour in Anguttarapa with a large Sangha of bhikkhus, with one thousand, two hundred and fifty bhikkhus, arrived at a market town of Anguttarapa called Apana. Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, heard: “The Master Gotama, son of the Sakyans, having gone forth from the Sakyan clan, has arrived at Apana. Now a good reputation has been spread about that Auspicious Gotama thus: “Truly is he the Auspicious One, the Arahant, rightly self-awakened, excelling in knowledge and conduct, well-farer, knower of worlds, incomparable charioteer of tamed persons, teacher of devas and humans, awakened, auspicious.” Having realized this world with its devas, maras and brahmas, together with the population of samanas and brahmanas, devas and humans, he causes to make it known. He teaches the Dhamma that is good in the beginning, good in the middle, good in the end, with the right meaning and phrasing, making known the life of purity that is utterly perfect and pure. Now good is the sight of such arahants.”

2. Then Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, visited with the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, he exchanged friendly greetings with the Auspicious One. Having exchange friendly greetings and cordial talk, he sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the Auspicious One instructed, aroused, energized, gladdened Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, with a Dhamma talk. Then Keniya,

0.0.1 selasuttam

1. evaṃ me sutam: ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā aṅguttarāpesu cārikaṃ caramāno mahatā bhikkhusaṅghena saddhiṃ aḍḍhatelāsehi bhikkhusatehi, yena āpaṇaṃ nāma aṅguttarāpānaṃ nigamo tadavasari. assosi kho keṇiyo jaṭilo samaṇo khalu bho gotamo sakyaputto sakyakulā pabbajito aṅguttarāpesu cārikaṃ caramāno mahatā bhikkhusaṅghena saddhiṃ aḍḍhatelāsehi bhikkhusatehi āpaṇaṃ anupatto. taṃ kho pana bhagavantam gotamaṃ evaṃ kalyāṇo kittisaddo abbhuggato: ‘itipi so bhagavā arahaṃ sammāsambuddho vijjācaraṇasampanno sugato lokavidū anuttaro purisadamma-sārathi satthā devamanussānaṃ buddho bhagavāti. so imaṃ lokaṃ sadevakaṃ samāraṃ sabrahmakam sasamaṇabrāhmaṇiṃ pajam sadevamanussaṃ sayam abhiññā sacchikatvā pavedeti. so dhammaṃ deseti ādikalyāṇaṃ majjhakalyāṇaṃ pariyośanakalyāṇaṃ sātthaṃ sabyañjanaṃ kevalaparipuṇṇaṃ parisuddhaṃ brahmacariyaṃ pakāseti. sādhu kho pana tathārūpānaṃ arahataṃ dassanaṃ hoti’ti.

2. atha kho keṇiyo jaṭilo yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkami. upasaṅkamitvā bhagavatā saddhiṃ sammodi. sammodanīyaṃ kathaṃ sārāṇīyaṃ vītisāretvā ekamantaṃ nisidi. ekamantaṃ nisinnaṃ kho keṇiyaṃ jaṭilaṃ bhagavā dhammiyā kathāya sandassesī samādapesi samuttejesī sampahaṃsesī. atha kho keṇiyo jaṭilo bhagavatā dhammiyā kathāya sandassito samādapito samuttejito sampahaṃsito bhagavantam etadvoca: ‘adhiṇāsetu me bhavaṃ gotamo svātānāya bhat-

the matted hair ascetic, having been instructed, aroused, energized, gladdened with a Dhamma talk, said this to the Auspicious One. “May Master Gotama, together with the bhikkhu sangha, consent to [accepting] tomorrow’s meal from me.” When thus was said, the Auspicious One said this to Keniya, the matted hair ascetic: “Large, O Keniya, is the bhikkhu sangha, one thousand, two hundred and fifty, and you place higher faith in the brahmins.” Also for a second time, Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, said this to the Auspicious One. “May Master Gotama, together with the bhikkhu sangha, consent to [accepting] tomorrow’s meal from me.” Also for a second time, the Auspicious One said this to Keniya, the matted hair ascetic: “Large, O Keniya, is the bhikkhu sangha, one thousand, two hundred and fifty, and you place higher faith in the brahmins.” Also for a third time, Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, said this to the Auspicious One. “May Master Gotama, together with the bhikkhu sangha, consent to [accepting] tomorrow’s meal from me.” The Auspicious One consented by silence.

3. Then, Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, having known of the Auspicious One’s consent, having risen up from his seat, stopped by his own hermitage. Upon arrival, he addressed his friends and colleagues, family and blood relations: “Hear me honorable friends and colleagues, family and blood relations. The samana Gotama, together with the bhikkhu sangha, have been invited by me for tomorrow’s meal. You may provide me with phys-

taṃ saddhiṃ bhikkhusaṅghenā'ti. evaṃ vutte bhagavā keṇiyaṃ jaṭilaṃ etadavoca: mahā kho keṇiya, bhikkhusaṅgho aḍḍhatelaṣāni bhikkhusatāni. tvañca kho brāhmaṇesu abhippasanno'ti. dutiyampi kho keṇiyo jaṭilo bhagavantam etadavoca: 'kiñcāpi bho gotama, mahā bhikkhusaṅgho, aḍḍhatelaṣāni bhikkhusatāni, ahañca brāhmaṇesu abhippasanno, adhivāsetu me bhavaṃ gotamo svātanāya bhattaṃ saddhiṃ bhikkhusaṅghenā'ti. dutiyampi kho bhagavā keṇiyaṃ jaṭilaṃ etadavoca: 'mahā kho keṇiya, bhikkhusaṅgho aḍḍhatelaṣāni bhikkhusatāni. tvañca kho brāhmaṇesu abhippasanno'ti. tatiyampi kho keṇiyo jaṭilo bhagavantam etadavoca: 'kiñcāpi bho gotama mahā bhikkhusaṅgho, aḍḍhatelaṣāni bhikkhusatāni. ahañca brāhmaṇesu abhippasanno, adhivāsetu me bhavaṃ gotamo svātanāya bhattaṃ saddhiṃ bhikkhusaṅghenā'ti. adhivāsesi bhagavā tuṇhībhāvena.

3. atha kho keṇiyo jaṭilo bhagavato adhivāsaṇaṃ viditvā utṭhāyāsanaṃ yena sako assamo tenupasaṅkami. upasaṅkamitvā mittāmacce ñātisālohite āmantesi: suṇantu me bhonto mittāmaccā ñātisālohitā, samaṇo me gotamo nimantito svātanāya bhattaṃ saddhiṃ bhikkhusaṅghena. yena me kāyaveyyāvaṭikaṃ¹ kareyyāthā'ti. evaṃ bho'ti kho keṇiyassa jaṭilassa mittāmaccā ñātisālohitā keṇiyassa jaṭilassa paṭissutvā appekacce uddhanāni khaṇanti, appekacce kaṭṭhāni phārenti, appekacce bhājanāni dhovanti, appekacce udakamaṇikaṃ patitṭhāpenti, appekacce āsanāni paññāpenti. keṇiyo pana jaṭilo sāmāññeva maṇḍalamālaṃ paṭiyādeti.

ical assistance.” “Yes Sir,” those friends and colleagues, family and blood relations of Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, having replied, some dug out ovens, some split-ted firewood, some washed pots, some set in place water vessels, some prepared seats, and Keniya, the matted hair ascetic himself, arranged a circular pavilion.

4. At that time the brahmin Sela was living at Apana, a knowledge master of the three vedas, of the vocabularies and the rituals, of the phonology and the etymology with the legends as the fifth, master of the verses and the grammar, well versed in the materialistic philosophy and the auspicious marks of a great man, and he taught the mantras to three hundred brahmin students. At that time Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, placed higher faith in the brahmin Sela. Then the brahmin Sela while walking and wandering about, accompanied by three hundred brahmin students, walking along back and forth, stopped by Keniya, the matted hair ascetic’s hermitage. The brahmin Sela saw some people digging out ovens at Keniya, the matted hair ascetic’s hermitage, some splitting firewood, some washing pots, some setting in place water vessels, some preparing seats, and Keniya, the matted hair ascetic himself, arranging a circular pavilion. Having seen, he said this to Keniya, the matted hair ascetic: “Is there going to be an engagement for you, Master Keniya, or is there going to be a marriage, or an offering of a great sacrifice, or is Seniya Bimbisara, the king of Magadha, together with his army invited for tomorrow?”

4. tena kho pana samayena selo brāhmaṇo āpaṇe pa-
 ṭivasati tiṇṇaṃ vedānaṃ pāragū sanighaṇḍuketubhā-
 naṃ sākharappabhedānaṃ itihāsapañcamānaṃ pa-
 dako veyyākaraṇo lokāyatamahāpurisalakkhaṇesu ana-
 vayo. tiṇi ca māṇavakasatāni mante vāceti. tena kho
 pana samayena keṇiyo jaṭilo sele brāhmaṇe abhippa-
 sanno hoti. atha kho selo brāhmaṇo tihi māṇavakasa-
 tehi parivuto jaṅghāvihāraṃ anucaṅkamamāno anu-
 vicaramāno yena keṇiyassa jaṭilassa assamo tenupa-
 saṅkami. addasā kho selo brāhmaṇo keṇiyassa jaṭi-
 lassa assame appekacce uddhanāni khaṇante, appe-
 kacce kaṭṭhāni phālente, appekacce bhājanāni dho-
 vante, appekacce udakamaṇikaṃ patitṭhāpente, ap-
 pekacce āsanāni paññāpente², keṇiyaṃ pana jaṭilaṃ
 sāmāññeva maṇḍalamālaṃ paṭiyādentam. disvāna ke-
 ṇiyaṃ jaṭilaṃ etadavoca: kinnu bhoto keṇiyassa āvāho
 vā bhavissati, vivāho vā bhavissati, mahāyañño vā pac-
 cupaṭṭhito, rājā vā māgadho seniyo bimbisāro niman-
 titito svātanāya saddhiṃ balakāyenā'ti. na me bho sela
 āvāho bhavissati, napi vivāho bhavissati, napi rājā mā-
 gadho seniyo bimbisāro nimantito svātanāya saddhiṃ
 balakāyena. api ca kho me mahāyañño paccupaṭṭhito.
 atthi bho samaṇo gotamo sakyaputto sakyakulā pab-
 bajito aṅguttarāpesu cārikaṃ caramāno mahatā bhik-
 khusaṅghena saddhiṃ aḍḍhateḷasehi bhikkhusatehi āpa-
 ṇaṃ anuppatto. tam kho pana bhagavantaṃ³ gota-
 maṃ evaṃ kalyāṇo kittisaddo abbhuggato: 'itipi so
 bhagavā arahaṃ sammāsambuddho vijjācaraṇasam-
 panno sugato lokavidū anuttaro purisadammasārathi
 satthā devamanussānaṃ buddho bhagavā'ti. so me ni-

“No, Master Sela, there is not going to be an engagement for me, nor is there going to be a marriage, nor an offering of a great sacrifice, nor is Seniya Bimbisara, the king of Magadha, together with his army invited for tomorrow.” Rather, [there will be] an offering of a great sacrifice by me. There is, Master, the samana Gotama, son of the Sakyans, having gone forth from the Sakyan clan, while wandering on tour in Anguttarapa with a large Sangha of bhikkhus, with one thousand, two hundred and fifty bhikkhus, has arrived at Apana. Now a good reputation has been spread about that Auspicious Gotama thus: “Truly is he the Auspicious One, the Arahant, rightly self-awakened, excelling in knowledge and conduct, well-farer, knower of worlds, incomparable charioteer of tamed persons, teacher of devas and humans, awakened, auspicious.” He has been invited by me, together with the bhikkhu sangha, for tomorrow’s meal.” Do you say “Buddha,” Master Keniya? I say “Buddha,” Master Sela? Do you say “Buddha,” Master Keniya? I say “Buddha,” Master Sela? Do you say “Buddha,” Master Keniya? I say “Buddha,” Master Sela?

5. Then for the brahmin Sela, this occurred: “Even this utterance is rare in the world, namely, “Buddha.” Moreover the thirty two auspicious marks of a great man has been handed down in our mantras, by which for the person endowed with those great marks, there are only two destinies, no other. If he lives the home life, he becomes a wheel turning monarch, a righteous king ruling by the

mantito svātanāya bhattaṃ saddhiṃ bhikkhusaṅghenā'ti.
 buddhoti bho keṇiya vadesi, buddhoti bho sela vadāmi.
 buddhoti bho keṇiya vadesi, buddhoti bho sela vadāmi.
 buddhoti bho keṇiya vadesi, buddhoti bho sela vadāmī'ti.

5. atha kho selassa brāhmaṇassa etadahosi: ghosopi
 kho eso dullabho lokasmiṃ yadidaṃ buddhoti. āga-
 tāni kho panasmākaṃ mantesu dvattiṃsa mahāpuri-
 salakkhaṇāni, yehi samannāgatassa mahāpurisassa dveva⁴
 gatiyo bhavanti anaññā. sace agāraṃ ajjhāvasati, rājā
 hoti cakkavattī dhammiko dhammarājā cāturato vi-
 jitāvī janapadatthāvariyaṃ appatto sattaratanasamannā-
 gato. tassimāni satta ratanāni bhavanti. seyyathidaṃ:
 cakkaratanaṃ hatthiratanāṃ assaratanaṃ maṇirata-
 naṃ itthiratanāṃ gahapatiratanāṃ parināyakarata-
 naṃ meva sattamaṃ. parosahassaṃ kho panassa puttā
 bhavanti sūrā viraṅgarūpā parasenappamaddanā. so
 imaṃ paṭhaviṃ sāgarapariyaṇṭaṃ adaṇḍena asatthena
 dhammena abhivijjiya ajjhāvasati. sace pana agāra-
 smā anagāriyaṃ pabbajati, arahamaṃ hoti sammāsa-
 buddho loke vivaṭṭacchada¹ kamaṃ pana bho keṇiya,
 etarahi so bhavaṃ gotamo viharati arahamaṃ sammā-
 sambuddho'ti. evaṃ vutte keṇiyo jaṭilo dakkhiṇaṃ
 bāhuṃ paggaḥetvā selaṃ brāhmaṇaṃ etadavoca: ye-
 nesā bho sela nīlavanarājī'ti.

6. atha kho selo brāhmaṇo tihi māṇavakasatehi sad-
 dhiṃ yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkami. atha kho selo
 brāhmaṇo te māṇavake āmantesi: appasaddā bhonto
 āgacchantu pāde pādaṃ² nikkhipantā, durāsadā hi te

dhamma, victorious king of the world who has attained stability of the country, endowed with the seven gems. That is: The wheel gem, the elephant gem, the horse gem, the jewel gem, the woman gem, the head of household gem, with the counsellor gem as the seventh. He has more than a thousand sons who are courageous, heroic, crushing the armies of others. He dwells having conquered by the Dhamma this earth bounded by the ocean without rod, without sword. If however, he goes forth from the home life into homelessness, then he becomes an arahant, a supremely awakened one proper, who rolls back the veil in the world. But where, O Master Keṇiya, is Master Gotama, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One proper, dwelling at present?" When thus was said, Keṇiya, the matted hair ascetic, having stretched forth his arm downwards, said this to the brahmin Sela: "By this role of dark green forest, O Master Sela."

6. Then the brahmin Sela, together with three hundred brahmin students, visited with the Auspicious One. Then the brahmin Sela addressed those students: "Be quiet, venerables. Approach putting your feet down step by step. Indeed difficult to meet with are those Auspicious Ones, like lions, faring alone, and when I am discussing with the samana, Master Gotama, do not you, venerable ones, interrupt us in the middle of our conversation. The venerable ones should wait for me to finish the conversation."

bhagavanto sīhāva ekacarā, yadā cāhaṃ bho sama-
 ñena gotamena saddhiṃ manteyyaṃ, mā me bhonto
 antarantarā kathaṃ opāsetha, kathāpariyosānaṃ me
 bhavanto āgamentū'ti.

7. atha kho selo brāhmaṇo yena bhagavā tenupasaṅ-
 kami. upasaṅkamitvā bhagavatā saddhiṃ sammodi.
 sammodanīyaṃ kathaṃ sārāṇīyaṃ vītisāretvā ekaman-
 taṃ nisīdi. ekamantaṃ nisinno kho selo brāhmaṇo
 bhagavato kāye dvattiṃsa mahāpurisalakkhaṇāni sam-
 mannesi³. addasā kho selo brāhmaṇo bhagavato kāye
 dvattiṃsa mahāpurisalakkhaṇāni yebhuyyena ṭhape-
 tvā dve. dvīsu mahāpurisalakkhaṇesu kaṅkhati vici-
 kicchati nādhimuccati na sampasīdati, kosohite ca vat-
 thaguyhe pahūtajivhatāya cā'ti. atha kho bhagavato
 etadahosi: passati kho me ayaṃ selo brāhmaṇo dvat-
 tiṃsa mahāpurisalakkhaṇāni yebhuyyena ṭhapetvā dve.
 dvīsu mahāpurisalakkhaṇesu kaṅkhati vicikicchati nā-
 dhimuccati na sampasīdati, kosohite ca vatthaguyhe,
 pahūtajivhatāya cāti. atha kho bhagavā tathārūpaṃ
 iddhābhisaṅkhāraṃ abhisaṅkhāsi yathā addasa selo
 brāhmaṇo bhagavato kosohitaṃ vatthaguyhaṃ. atha
 kho bhagavā jivhaṃ ninnāmetvā ubhopi kaṇṇasotāni
 anumasi parimasi⁴ ubhopi nāsikāsotāni⁵ anumasi pa-
 rimasi. kevalampi⁶ lalāṭamaṇḍalaṃ⁷ jivhāya chādesi.

8. atha kho selassa brāhmaṇassa etadahosi: saman-
 nāgato kho samaṇo gotamo dvattiṃsa mahāpurisalak-
 khaṇehi paripuṇṇehi, no aparipuṇṇehi, no ca kho naṃ
 jānāmi buddho vā no vā. suttaṃ kho pana metaṃ brā-

7. Then the brahmin Sela, approached the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, he exchanged friendly greetings with the Auspicious One. Having exchange friendly greetings and cordial talk, he sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the brahmin Sela looked for the thirty two auspicious marks of a great man on the Auspicious One's body. The brahmin Sela saw on the Auspicious One's body most of the thirty two auspicious marks of a great man except for two. Among these two auspicious marks of a great man he had perplexity, doubt, indecision, uncertainty, "the male organ enclosed in sheath, and the largeness of the tongue." Then for the Auspicious One this occurred: This brahmin Sela sees most of the thirty two auspicious marks of a great man on me except for two. Among these two auspicious marks of a great man he has perplexity, doubt, indecision, uncertainty, "the male organ enclosed in sheath, and the largeness of the tongue." So then the Auspicious One perform such an exhibition of superhuman powers that the brahmin Sela saw the Auspicious One's male organ enclosed in a sheath. Then the Auspicious One, having put out his tongue, touched and stroked both ear holes and also touched and stroked both nostrils. He also covered the entire forehead with his tongue.

8. So then this occurred to the brahmin Sela: "The samana Gotama is endowed with the thirty two auspicious marks of a great man, fully complete, not incomplete, but I don't know if he is a Buddha or not. But I have

hmaṇānaṃ vuddhānaṃ mahallakānaṃ ācariyapācari-
yānaṃ bhāsamānānaṃ. ye te bhavanti arahanto sam-
māsambuddhā, te sake vaṇṇe bhaññaṃāne attānaṃ
pātukaronti. yannūnāhaṃ samaṇaṃ gotamaṃ sam-
mukhā sārubbāhi gāthāhi abhitthaveyya'nti.

9. atha kho selo brāhmaṇo bhagavantaṃ sammukhā
sārubbāhi gāthāhi abhitthavi.

paripuṇṇakāyo suruci sujāto cārudassano,
suvaṇṇavaṇṇosi bhagavā susukkadāṭhosi vi-
riyavā¹

narassa hi sujātassa ye bhavanti viyañjanā,
12sabbe te tava kāyasmim mahāpurisalak-
khaṇā.

pasannanetto sumukho brahā³ uju patāpavā,

majjhe samaṇasaṅghassa ādiccova virocasi.

kalyāṇadassano bhikkhu kañcanasannibhat-
taco,

kinte samaṇabhāvena evaṃ uttamavaṇṇino.

rājā arahasi bhavitum cakkavattī rathesabho,

cāturanto vijitāvī jambusaṇḍassa⁴ issaro.

khattiyā bhogī rājāno⁵ anuyuttā⁶ bhavantu

heard this said by brahmins of old, of ancient times, teachers of teachers: Those arahants, the supremely awakened ones proper, manifest themselves when their own praises are being expounded. What if I were to praise the samana Gotama in his presence with fitting verses?”

9. So then the brahmin Sela praised the Auspicious One in his presence with fitting verses.

With a perfect body, handsome, well-born,
lovely to behold,
with a golden-colored complexion, the Auspicious One is heroic, with extremely white teeth.

Indeed for a man who is well born, those to
whom distinctive marks come to be,
all those auspicious marks of a great man are
on your body.

With bright eyes, handsome face, broad, straight,
majestic,
amidst the sangha of samanas, you shine like
the sun.

A bhikkhu good to gaze upon, with skin like
gold,
what have you to do with being a samana,
with such supreme complexion?

te,
rājābhirājā manujindo rajjaṃ kārehi gotama.

rājāhamasmi selā'ti dhammarājā anuttaro,
dhammena cakkaṃ vattemi cakkaṃ appati-
vattiyaṃ⁷.

sambuddho paṭijānāsi dhammarājā anuttaro,
dhammena cakkaṃ vattemi iti bhāsasi go-
tama.

ko nu senāpati bhoto sāvako satthuranvayo⁸,
ko te imaṃ anuvatteti⁹ dhammacakkaṃ pa-
vattitaṃ.

mayā pavattitaṃ cakkaṃ (selāti bhagavā) dham-
macakkaṃ anuttaraṃ,
sāriputto anuvatteti anujāto tathāgataṃ.

abhiññeyyaṃ abhiññātaṃ bhāvetabbañca bhā-
vitaṃ,
pahātabbaṃ pahīnaṃ me tasmā buddhosmi
brāhmaṇa.

vinayassu mayi kaṅkhaṃ adhimuccassu brā-
hmaṇa,
dullabhaṃ dassanaṃ hoti sambuddhānaṃ
abhiñhaso.

You are worthy to be a king, a wheel turning
monarch, the foremost leader,
victorious ruler of the earth bounded by the
four oceans.

A khattiya enjoying sovereignty, let them be
your vassals,
king of kings, lord of men, Gotama, claim your
kingdom.

“A king am I, O Sela,” the king of Dhamma
unsurpassed,
I roll the wheel of Dhamma, the wheel that
cannot be rolled back.

He acknowledges supreme awakening, the king
of Dhamma unsurpassed,
I roll the wheel of Dhamma, thus speaks Go-
tama.

Who is your general, the venerable disciple
who emulates the Teacher,
Who is your successor, that continues to roll
the wheel of the Dhamma for you?

By me the wheel is set in motion, the wheel of
Dhamma unsurpassed,
Sariputta keeps it rolling, following the exam-
ple of the Tathagata.

yesaṃ ve dullabho loke pātubhāvo abhiñhaso,
sohaṃ brāhmaṇa sambuddho sallakatto anut-
taro.

brahmabhūto atitulo mārasenappamaddano,
sabbāmitte¹⁰ vasī katvā modāmi akutobhayo.

imaṃ bhonto nisāmetha yathā bhāsati cak-
khumā,
sallakatto mahāvīro sīhova nadatī vane.

brahmabhūtaṃ atitulaṃ mārasenappamad-
danaṃ,
ko disvā nappasīdeyya api kaṇhābhijātiko.

yo maṃ icchatī anvetu yo vānicchatī gac-
chatu,
idhāhaṃ pabbajissāmi varapaññassa santike.

etañce¹² ruccatī bhoto sammāsambuddha-
sāsaṇaṃ²,
mayampi pabbajissāma varapaññassa san-
tike.

brāhmaṇā tisatā ime yācanti pañjalikatā,
brahmacariyaṃ carissāma bhagavā tava san-
tike.

What should be supremely known is supremely
 known, what should be enculturated is
 enculturated,
 What should be abandoned is abandoned by
 me. Therefore, O brahmin, I am a Bud-
 dha.

Remove your doubt in me, be decisive, O brah-
 min,
 always difficult to gain is the sight of the supremely
 awakened ones.

Truly of those whose appearance is always
 difficult to gain in the world,
 that I am, O brahmin, the supremely awakened
 one, the unsurpassed surgeon.

An embodiment of Brahma, unrivalled, crusher
 of Mara's army,
 having overpowered all enemies, I rejoice with
 nothing to fear from any quarter.

Listen to this, O honorables, as the one en-
 dowed with eyes speaks,
 the surgeon, the great hero, like a lion roaring
 in the forest.

An embodiment of Brahma, unrivalled, crusher
 of Mara's army,
 who having seen would not gain confidence,

svākkhātaṃ brahmacariyaṃ (selāti bhagavā)
 sandiṭṭhikamakālikam,
 yattha amoghā pabbajjā appamattassa sik-
 khatoti.

12. alattha kho selo brāhmaṇo sapaṇiso bhagavato santike pabbajjam, alattha upasampadam. atha kho keṇiyo jaṭilo tassā rattiyā accayena sake assame paṇītaṃ khādanīyaṃ bhojanīyaṃ paṭiyādāpetvā bhagavato kālaṃ ārocāpesi: ‘kālo bho gotama, niṭṭhitam bhatta’nti. atha kho bhagavā pubbaṇhasamayam nivāsetvā pattacīvaram ādāya yena keṇiyassa jaṭilassa assamo tenupasaṅkami. upasaṅkamtvā paññatte āsane nisīdi saddhim bhikkhusaṅghena.

13. atha kho keṇiyo jaṭilo buddhapamukham³ bhikkhusaṅgham paṇītena khādanīyena bhojanīyena sahatthā santappesi sampavāresi. atha kho keṇiyo jaṭilo bhagavantam bhuttāvim onītapattapāṇim aññataram nīcam āsanam gahetvā ekamantaṃ nisīdi. ekamantaṃ nisinnaṃ kho keṇiyam jaṭilaṃ bhagavā imāhi gāthāhi anumodi.

aggihuttamukhā yaññā sāvittī chandaso mu-
 kham,
 rājā mukham manussānam nadīnam sāgaro
 mukham.

nakkhattānam mukham cando ādicco tapa-
 taṃ mukham,

except one born of dark [nature].

He who wishes should follow me, he who does
not wish should go,
here I will go forth, in the presence of the one
with excellent wisdom .

If the instructions of this supremely awakened
one proper pleases the master,
we too will go forth, in the presence of the one
with excellent wisdom.

These three hundred brahmins request with
hands in anjali,
we will fare, O Auspicious One, the life of
purity in your presence.

“Well-proclaimed is life of purity, visible here
and now, not involving time,
where the going forth is not empty for one
who trains with vigilance.”

12. Then the brahmin Sela together with his assembly gained the going forth in the presence of the Auspicious One, they gained the higher ordination. Then with the passing of the night, Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, having prepared excellent hard foods and soft foods in his own hermitage, announced to the Auspicious One: “It is time Master Gotama, the meal is ready.” So then in

puññaṃ ākaṅkhamānānaṃ saṅgho ve yaja-
taṃ mukha'nti.

14. atha kho bhagavā keṇiyaṃ jaṭilaṃ imāhi gāthāhi anumoditvā utṭhāyāsanaṃ pakkāmi. atha kho āyasmā selo sapaṇiso eko vūpakaṭṭho appamatto ātāpī pahitatto viharanto na cirasseva yassatthāya kulaputtā sammadeva agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajanti. tadanuttaraṃ brahmacariyapariyosānaṃ diṭṭheva dhamme sayamaṃ abhiññaṃ sacchikatvā upasampajja vihāsi. khīṇa jāti, vusitaṃ brahmacariyaṃ, kataṃ karaṇiyaṃ, nāparaṃ itthattāyāti abbhaññaṃ. aññataro ca kho paṇāyasmā selo sapaṇiso arahataṃ ahosi.

15. atha kho āyasmā selo sapaṇiso yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkamaṃ, upasaṅkamtvā ekaṃsaṃ cīvaram kaṭvā yena bhagavā tenañjalimpaṇāmetvā bhagavantaṃ gāthāya ajjhabhāsi.

yantaṃ saraṇamāgamaṃ ito aṭṭhamī cakkhumā¹,

sattarattena² bhagavā dantaṃhā³ tava sāsane.

tuvaṃ buddho tuvaṃ satthā tuvaṃ mārābhibhū muni,

tuvaṃ anusaye chetvā tiṇṇo tāresimaṃ pajamaṃ.

upadhī te samatikkantā āsavā te padālitaṃ,

the morning, the Auspicious One having dressed, having taken bowl and robe, approached Keniya, the matted hair ascetic's hermitage. Upon arrival, he sat down on a prepared seat with the bhikkhu sangha.

13. So then Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, with his own hands, served and satisfied the community of bhikkhus headed by the Buddha with excellent hard foods and soft foods. Then, when the Auspicious One had eaten and removed his hand from the bowl, Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, having taken a certain lower seat, sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the Auspicious One rejoiced in Keniya, the matted hair ascetic's [generosity] with these verses.

“The fire-oblation is the cheif of sacrifices, the
metre is the chief of verses,
the king is the chief of humans, the ocean is
the chief of rivers.

The moon is the cheif of the constellation, the
sun is the chief of luminaries,
for those seeking merits, the sangha is indeed
the chief of [recipients of] sacrifice.”

14. Then the Auspicious One, having rejoiced in [the generosity of] Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, with these verses, having risen up from his seat, departed. Then the venerable Sela, together with his assembly, dwelling

sīhova anupādāno pahīnabhayabheravo.

bhikkhavo tisatā ime tiṭṭhanti pañjalīkatā,
pāde vīra pasārehi nāgā vandantu satthuno'ti.

alone, withdrawn, vigilant, ardent, resolute, not long entered upon and dwelled in that unsurpassed consummation of the life of purity for the sake of which sons of clansmen justly and rightly go forth from the household life into homelessness, having realized it with their own supreme knowledge in just this very life. They understood: “Destroyed is birth, lived is the life of purity, done is what had to be done, there is nothing else [to do] for thusness.” And the venerable Sela, together with his assembly, all became one of the arahants.

15. Then the venerable Sela, together with his assembly, approached the Auspicious One. Having approached, having arranged his robe on one shoulder, having stretched out his hands in anjali towards the Auspicious One, addressed the Auspicious One in verses.

“It is the eighth day since having gone to the
one endowed with eyes as refuge.
For seven days, we have been tamed by your
instructions, O Auspicious One.

You are the Buddha, you are the Teacher, you
are the sage, vanquisher of Mara,
you having cut the underlying tendencies, crossed,
you lead the population across.

Those who overcome ownership, those who
split asunder the asavas,

like a lion without undertakings, having abandoned fear and dread.

These three hundred bhikkhus, stand with
hands in anjali,
stretch out your feet, O hero, [let them] pay
homage to the Teacher, the Naga.”

